KEY TOPIC 4: LIFE IN NAZI GERMANY, 1933–39

Paper 3: Weimar and Nazi Germany, 1918–39



COURSE TEXTBOOK

Enquiry: *From Democracy to Dictatorship: How did Hitler destroy the Weimar Republic?*

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L1: Key Topic 4.1: Nazi Policies Towards Women, 1933–1939

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- [ ] Demonstrate precise knowledge of the laws and incentives used to increase the birth rate and promote traditional marriage.
- [ ] Analyse the methods used by the NS-Frauenschaft and the Deutsches Frauenwerk to control women's daily lives and education.
- [ ] Evaluate the 'great contradiction' of Nazi policy: why female employment actually increased between 1933 and 1939 despite ideological attempts to force women out of the workplace.

Recall & Retrieval

1. Who was Joseph Goebbels?

2. Name two methods of Nazi propaganda.

3. Who were the SS (Schutzstaffel)?

4. What was the Gestapo?

5. What was the role of concentration camps in the 1930s?

6. What was the Enabling Act?

7. What was the Night of the Long Knives?

8. Who was Ernst Röhm?

9. What happened to the Reichstag in 1933?

10. What title did Hitler take in 1934?

Vocabulary Check

The Odd One Out: *Circle ONE term that does not belong with the others. Explain your reasoning: What historical connection links the other terms, and why is your chosen term different?*

Kinder, Küche, Kirche | Law for the Encouragement of Marriage (1933) | The Mother's Cross (Mutterkreuz) | Lebensborn (Spring of Life) | NS-Frauenschaft (NSF) | Deutsches Frauenwerk (DFW) | Gertrud Scholtz-Klink

Teacher Model / Pupil Reasoning:



1. The Ideological Shift: Reversing Weimar Freedoms During the Weimar Republic (1924–1929), German women had achieved some of the most progressive rights in Europe (Article 109 gave them equal voting rights, and millions entered professions). Hitler viewed this as a disaster. In Nazi ideology, men and women had entirely different, biological roles: men were warriors and breadwinners; women were mothers, responsible for breeding the pure Aryan race (the 'Volksgemeinschaft'). The Weimar 'New

Woman' was to be replaced by the traditional, rural mother.

> **Lived Experience: Marianne Gartner (Young Austrian woman recalling Nazi marriage loans and expectations)**
> "A woman's place was strictly defined. We were encouraged to leave jobs and marry young. If you produced four children, you were presented with the Mother's Cross like a decorated soldier of the home front."

2. Increasing the Birth Rate: Rewards and Bribes The birth rate had fallen to just one million births per year by 1933. To prepare for future wars, Hitler needed soldiers. The Nazis used a mix of financial bribes and radical policies to force the birth rate up: * **The Law for the Encouragement of Marriage (1933):** The government offered loans of 1,000 marks (equivalent to 8 months' wages) to young, racially pure couples to marry. However, the loan was only granted if the woman quit her job. For every child born, 25% of the loan was wiped out. Having four children meant the loan was completely forgiven. * **The Mother's Cross ('Mutterkreuz'):** Motherhood was glorified as a service to the state. Medals were awarded every year on August 12th (Hitler's mother's birthday): Bronze for 4/5 children, Silver for 6/7, and Gold for 8 or more. Hitler Youth members were legally ordered to salute women wearing the Gold cross. * **Changes to Divorce Laws (1938):** If a wife could not—or would not—have children, or if she had an abortion, this could now be used by the husband as legal grounds for divorce. * **The 'Lebensborn' Programme (1935):** Run by Heinrich Himmler and the SS. Initially a nursery for SS wives, it evolved into a state-sponsored breeding programme. Single women who met strict Aryan racial criteria volunteered to be impregnated by carefully selected SS officers to create 'genetically pure' children for the state.

3. The Dark Side of the Policy: Eugenics and Sterilisation 'Grade 9 nuance:' The Nazis only wanted 'Aryan' and 'healthy' women to breed. For those who did not fit this ideal, the policies were brutal. * **The Law for the Prevention of Hereditarily Diseased Offspring (1933):** Also known as the Sterilisation Law, this allowed the government to forcefully sterilise women deemed "unfit" to be mothers (e.g., those with mental illnesses, physical disabilities, or deafness). Over 320,000 people were sterilised under this law. * **The Marriage Health Law (1935):** Stressed the absolute necessity of "racial purity," banning marriages between Aryans and those deemed genetically or racially "inferior".

4. Controlling Appearance, Daily Life, and Education The Nazis dictated exactly how the ideal German woman should look and behave, enforced through propaganda and social pressure: * **Appearance:** They were expected to wear traditional German peasant dresses. Trousers, high heels, and cosmetics/makeup were heavily discouraged in favour of flat shoes and plain, traditional German peasant dresses (Dirndl). Hair had to be kept natural and tied back in plaits/braids or a bun; perming, curling, or dyeing hair was strictly condemned as 'un-German'. * **Lifestyle Restrictions:** Women were banned from smoking in public (it was considered harmful to fertility) and discouraged from slimming/dieting, as the Nazis believed heavier women had easier childbirths. * **Organisations:** Hitler appointed Gertrud Scholtz-Klink as the Reich Women’s Leader. She oversaw the elite **NS-Frauenschaft** (National Socialist Women's League). All independent women's groups were banned and merged into the massive **Deutsches Frauenwerk (DFW)**, which by 1939 had 6 million members. It ran motherhood schools, teaching millions of women how to cook, clean, and raise children according to Nazi ideology. * **Education:** To keep women focused on the 'Three Ks' ('Kinder, Küche, Kirche'), female enrolment in universities was strictly limited to a maximum quota of **10%**.

5. Employment: The Great Contradiction This is a crucial analytical point. The Nazis 'wanted' women out of the workplace, but their own economic and military goals made this impossible. * **Initial Removals (1933–1936):** Women were forced out of professional careers. In 1933, female doctors, civil servants, and teachers were sacked. In 1936, women were banned from being judges or serving on juries. * **The Reversal (1937–1939):** In 1936, Hermann Göring introduced the **Four Year Plan** to secretly rearm Germany for war. This created a massive labor shortage in factories as men joined the army. By 1937, the Nazis were forced to abandon their ideology. They needed women back in the factories. They abolished the marriage loan requirement that women had to quit work, and introduced a "compulsory duty year" requiring women to work in agriculture or industry. * **The Result:** Nazi employment policy towards women was an ideological failure. Despite spending years telling women to stay at home, the number of women in employment actually **rose** from 11.6 million in 1933 to 14.6 million in 1939.

Pair & Share Activity

Q1. Discuss with your partner: Did Nazi policies towards women succeed in their goals?

The 'But/Because/So' Strategy

Q2. Complete these sentences based on the lesson's core narrative: 1) Nazi policies aimed to confine women to the roles of "Kinder, Küche, Kirche" BUT... 2) The Law for the Encouragement of Marriage was introduced BECAUSE... 3) The Nazis created organizations like the NS-Frauenschaft SO...

Vocabulary in Context

Q3. Using the keywords 'Kinder, Küche, Kirche', 'Law for the Encouragement of Marriage', 'The Mother's Cross', and 'Gertrud Scholtz-Klink', write a short paragraph explaining how Nazi policies aimed to shape women's lives in the 1930s.

Causal Linkage

Q4. Explain how the Nazi ideology of racial purity and the urgent need for population growth led directly to the implementation of programs like the 'Lebensborn' and the creation of 'The Mother's Cross'.

Counter-Factual History

Q5. What if the Nazi regime had not faced severe labour shortages due to rearmament? How might their policies towards women's employment have evolved differently, and what would be the long-term implications for German society?

L2: Key Topic 4.2: Nazi Policies Towards the Young, 1933–1939

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- [ ] Demonstrate precise knowledge of how the school curriculum and teaching profession were completely 'Nazified' by Bernhard Rust.
- [ ] Analyse the differences between the youth movements for boys (military preparation) and girls (domestic preparation).
- [ ] Evaluate the extent to which Nazi youth policies were a success, acknowledging the Grade 9 nuance that resistance did exist.

Recall & Retrieval

1. What were the 'Three Ks' for women in Nazi Germany?

2. What was the Law for the Encouragement of Marriage?

3. What was the Mother's Cross?

4. What was the Hitler Youth?

5. How did schools change under the Nazis?

6. Who was Joseph Goebbels?

7. What was the Gestapo?

8. Who led the SS?

9. What was the Enabling Act?

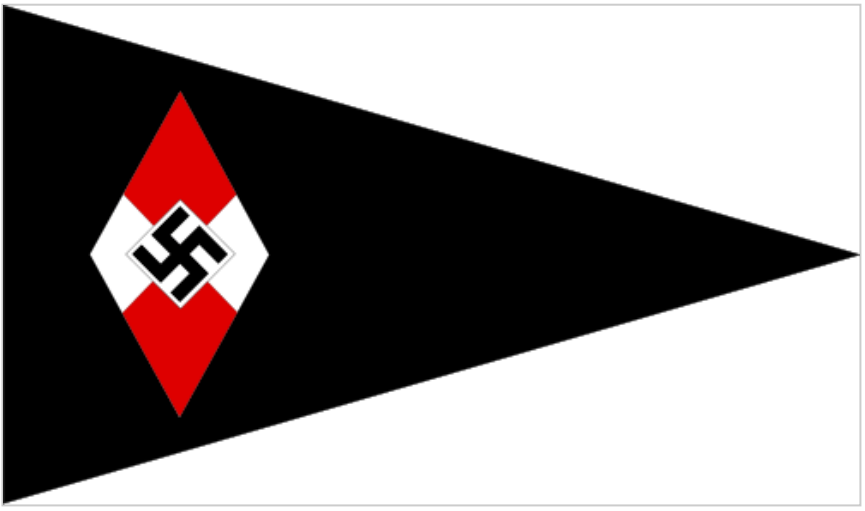
10. Who were the 'November Criminals'?

Vocabulary Check

The Golden Sentence: *Choose TWO terms from the word bank. Write ONE grammatically sophisticated, historically accurate sentence connecting them using a causal conjunction (because, although, or consequently):*

Indoctrination | National Socialist Teachers' League (NSLB) | Bernhard Rust | Eugenics (Race Studies) | Hitlerjugend (HJ) | Bund Deutscher Mädel (BDM) | Faith and Beauty Society

Teacher Model / Pupil Sentence:



1. The Goal: A Thousand Year Reich Hitler knew that adults who had grown up in the democratic Weimar Republic might never fully accept Nazism. Therefore, his priority was the youth. The goal was to raise a generation of fiercely loyal, racially pure, athletic fanatics who placed their obedience to Hitler above their

own parents. To achieve this, the state took control of both their school hours and their free time.

> **Lived Experience: Alfons Heck (Former Hitler Youth member, *A Child of Hitler*)**
> "I belonged to Adolf Hitler body and soul. From our tenth year onward, we were indoctrinated into believing that dying for the Fatherland was the highest honor a boy could achieve."

2. Controlling the Teachers Education Minister Bernhard Rust stated that the whole purpose of education was to create Nazis. * **Purging the Profession:** In April 1933, the 'Law for the Restoration of the Professional Civil Service' was passed. This was immediately used to sack Jewish teachers and any teachers known to have supported the Communist or Social Democratic parties. * **The NSLB:** All remaining teachers were heavily pressured to join the **National Socialist Teachers' League (NSLB)**. By 1939, 97% of teachers had joined. They were forced to attend one-month training camps to learn Nazi ideology and physical drill. If a teacher did not teach the Nazi way, students were encouraged to report them to the Gestapo.

3. Nazifying the Curriculum and Classrooms The school timetable and environment were completely rewritten to serve the state: * **Physical Education:** PE time was doubled, eventually taking up a massive **15%** of the school timetable. This was to prepare boys for the army and girls to be healthy mothers. * **Race Studies (Eugenics):** A brand new compulsory subject. Students were taught how to measure skulls and classify races, learning that Aryans were superior and Jews were subhuman 'parasites'. * **History:** History textbooks were entirely rewritten to focus on the 'stab-in-the-back' myth of WWI and the glorious rise of the Nazi Party. From 1935, all textbooks had to be state-approved, and Hitler's autobiography, 'Mein Kampf', became a compulsory text. * **Maths:** Even maths became a tool for propaganda. Word problems asked students to calculate the fuel required to bomb Warsaw, or the financial cost to the state of keeping disabled people in asylums. * **Jewish Students:** Jewish children were deliberately humiliated in class (often used as 'examples' during Race Studies). By 1938, Jewish children were banned from attending German schools entirely. **4. Elite Schools** For the most promising Aryan boys, the Nazis set up elite boarding schools to train the future leaders of the SS and the government: **Napolas** (National Political Educational Institutes, run by the SS) and **Adolf Hitler Schools** (run by the Hitler Youth). These schools functioned like military boot camps, focusing heavily on physical combat, endurance, and ruthless competition.

Extracurricular Control: The Youth Movements To control children outside of school hours, Hitler appointed Baldur von Schirach as the Reich Youth Leader. All other youth groups (like the Boy Scouts or Catholic youth groups) were banned or absorbed. Crucially, the Hitler Youth aimed to undermine family loyalty; teenagers were encouraged to inform on their own parents if they heard them criticising the regime. **The Path for Boys:** * **Ages 10–14:** 'Deutsches Jungvolk' (DJ - German Young People). * **Ages 14–18:** 'Hitlerjugend' (HJ - Hitler Youth). * **Activities:** The focus was purely on military preparation. Boys engaged in regular hiking, camping, map-reading, and rifle shooting. They were subjected to harsh physical punishments to toughen them up and swore a blood oath of personal loyalty to Hitler. **The Path for Girls:** * **Ages 10–14:** 'Jungmädelbund' (JM - Young Girls). * **Ages 14–18:** 'Bund Deutscher Mädel' (BDM - League of German Maidens). * **Ages 17-21 (Grade 9 point):** The **Faith and Beauty Society** ('Glaube und Schönheit') was set up in 1938. The Nazis were worried girls would forget their domestic training in the gap between leaving the BDM at 18 and marrying, so this group kept them under Nazi control until they joined the adult women's league. * **Activities:** The focus was on health and preparation for motherhood. Girls were taught domestic chores, cooking, and how to spot a racially pure husband. They also took part in gymnastics and cross-country running to ensure they were physically fit for childbirth.

5. Success or Failure? (Grade 9 Analysis) * **The Success:** Initially, the youth movements were highly successful and popular. Young people enjoyed the camping, sports, and the sense of power it gave them over their parents. In 1936, the **Hitler Youth Law** made it state policy, and in 1939, a Second Hitler Youth Law made membership strictly compulsory. By 1939, membership stood at around **8 million**. * **The Failure:** However, by the late 1930s, the system was beginning to crack. As the Hitler Youth became strictly compulsory, it became less about fun and more about boring military drill and endless political speeches. This resentment directly fueled the rise of opposition groups like the **Edelweiss Pirates** and the **Swing Youth**, proving that indoctrination was never 100% successful.

Pair & Share Activity

Q1. Discuss with your partner: Were the Hitler Youth effective in controlling the young?

The 'But/Because/So' Strategy

Q2. Complete the following sentences based on the lesson: 1) The Nazi regime introduced significant changes to the school curriculum BUT... 2) Membership in the Hitlerjugend (HJ) and Bund Deutscher Mädel (BDM) became compulsory BECAUSE... 3) Teachers faced pressure to join the NSLB and swear loyalty to Hitler, SO...

Vocabulary in Context

Q3. Explain how the following keywords relate to Nazi policies towards the young, using specific examples from the lesson narrative: Indoctrination, National Socialist Teachers' League (NSLB), Eugenics (Race Studies), Hitlerjugend (HJ), Bund Deutscher Mädel (BDM).

Causal Linkage

Q4. How did the Nazi regime's control over the education system and its establishment of compulsory youth organizations (HJ and BDM) *together* serve to consolidate their power and prepare Germany for its long-term goals by 1939?

The 'What If' Challenge

Q5. What if the Nazi regime had *failed* to gain significant control over the education system and youth organizations by 1939? How might this have impacted their ability to consolidate power, prepare for war, and maintain public support in the long term?

L3: Key Topic 4.3: Employment and Living Standards, 1933–1939

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- [ ] Demonstrate precise knowledge of the government schemes used to reduce unemployment (RAD, public works, and rearmament).
- [ ] Analyse the shift in economic leadership from Schacht's 'New Plan' to Goering's 'Four Year Plan' and the goal of Autarky.
- [ ] Evaluate the extent to which the Nazi economic recovery was a statistical illusion (invisible unemployment) and assess the true impact on living standards.

Recall & Retrieval

1. What were the 'Three Ks' (Kinder, Küche, Kirche) expected of women in Nazi Germany?

2. What financial incentive did the 1933 Law for the Encouragement of Marriage offer young couples?

3. What was the Mother's Cross awarded for?

4. What was the Hitler Youth (Hitlerjugend / HJ)?

5. What was the League of German Girls (Bund Deutscher Mädel / BDM)?

6. How did the school curriculum change under the Nazis?

7. Who were the Edelweiss Pirates?

8. Who was Joseph Goebbels?

9. What was the Gestapo?

10. What was the Night of the Long Knives (June 1934)?

Vocabulary Check

Conceptual Classification: *Categorise the terms from the word bank into the two historical boxes below:*

Invisible Unemployment | Autarky | Ersatz | Hermann Goering | National Labour Service (RAD) | German Labour Front (DAF) | Strength Through Joy (KdF) | Beauty of Labour (SdA)

Power, Governance & Warfare	Economy, Trade & Society



1. The Unemployment Crisis & Job Creation When Hitler became Chancellor in January 1933, nearly 6 million Germans were officially unemployed. By 1939, this figure was reported as just 300,000. The Nazis achieved this through massive state-funded projects: * **The National Labour Service (RAD):** From 1935, it

became compulsory for all men aged 18–25 to serve six months. They lived in military-style camps, wore uniforms, and did low-paid manual labour like draining swamps. * **Public Works (The Autobahns):** Hitler planned a 7,000-mile network of dual-carriageway motorways. By 1938, over 100,000 men were employed in construction.

> **Lived Experience: A German industrial worker (Report to the underground SPD (Sopade), Ruhr Valley 1937)**
> "There is work, yes, but we are prisoners of the factory. The DAF takes our dues, strikes are outlawed, and wages are frozen while food prices climb. The KdF holidays are for the party bosses, not for us."

2. The Grade 9 Reality: 'Invisible Unemployment' The Nazi 'economic miracle' was heavily manipulated. The official figures **ignored**: * **Jews:** Hundreds of thousands were sacked from their jobs but not counted on the register. * **Women:** Women dismissed from professions or who gave up work for a marriage loan were not counted. * **Political Prisoners:** Hundreds of thousands held in concentration camps were excluded. * **Part-time workers:** Anyone working even a few hours a week was counted as fully employed. * **Conscription:** Reintroduced in 1935. The army grew from 100,000 to 1.4 million by 1939. These men were removed from unemployment statistics.

3. Economic Leadership: Schacht vs. Goering To understand the Nazi economy, you must understand the shift in leadership: * **The New Plan (1934–1937):** Run by Hjalmar Schacht. He focused on reducing imports and making clever trade agreements to solve Germany's economic crisis. He was successful but was sacked because he told Hitler that rapid rearmament was bankrupting the country. * **The Four Year Plan (1936–1939):** Run by Hermann Goering. His primary goal was to prepare the economy for war within four years. His main focus was **Autarky** (self-sufficiency). Billions were poured into arms manufacturing (aviation employment rose from 4,000 to 72,000 in two years) and developing **Ersatz** (substitute) goods, like extracting oil from coal or making synthetic rubber (Buna), so Germany could survive a naval blockade.

4. Controlling the Workers: The DAF In May 1933, Hitler banned all trade unions and strikes. To replace them, he set up the **German Labour Front (DAF)**, run by Robert Ley. Every worker had to join. Employers could set wages as they pleased, and workers could not negotiate or quit without permission. To bribe the workers into accepting this loss of freedom, the DAF set up two sub-organisations: * **Strength Through Joy (KdF):** Provided state-subsidised leisure activities like theatre tickets and luxury cruises to loyal workers. * **The Volkswagen Scheme:** A KdF savings scheme where workers paid 5 marks a week towards a 'People's Car'. It was a scam—in 1939, factories switched to military vehicles, and no civilian ever received a car or a refund. * **Beauty of Labour (SdA):** Campaigned for better factory facilities. 'Nuance:' While facilities improved, employers forced the workers to build these canteens themselves during unpaid free time.

5. Winners and Losers: Did Living Standards Improve? The idea that everyone was better off under the Nazis is a myth. * **The Winners (Big Business & Farmers):** Giant monopolies like IG Farben and Krupp made fortunes from government rearmament contracts. Farmers benefited initially from the 'Reich Entailed Farm Law' (1933), which protected their land from being seized for debt (though it also meant they couldn't sell it). * **The Losers (Small Businesses & Workers):** Small businesses ('Mittelstand') were squeezed out by big department stores and high taxes; roughly 20% went bankrupt. For the average worker, the working week increased from 43 hours in 1933 to 49 hours in 1939. Because the government prioritized military spending ('Guns over Butter') and Ersatz goods were expensive to produce, the price of basic groceries rose faster than wages. **Conclusion:** Workers had job security, but their purchasing power (real wages) fell compared to the Weimar era.

Pair & Share Activity

Q1. Discuss with your partner: Did living standards really improve for workers under the Nazis?

True/False/Justify

Q2. Read the following statements. For each, state whether it is True or False, and then justify your answer using specific evidence from the lesson narrative.

1. Nazi Germany completely eliminated unemployment by 1939 through genuine, sustainable economic growth.
2. The Four Year Plan, led by Hermann Goering, aimed to make Germany economically self-sufficient and prepare for war.
3. Living standards for most Germans significantly improved between 1933 and 1939, with an abundance of consumer goods.

Vocabulary in Context

Q3. Write a short paragraph (5-7 sentences) explaining how the Nazi regime managed both employment figures and public perception of living standards between 1933 and 1939. You must accurately use at least FIVE of the following keywords: Invisible Unemployment, Autarky, Ersatz, Hermann Goering, National Labour Service (RAD), German Labour Front (DAF), Strength Through Joy (KdF), Beauty of Labour (SdA). Underline or bold the keywords you use.

Causal Linkage

Q4. Explain the complex relationship between the Nazi regime's rearmament goals, the official reduction in unemployment, and the actual living standards of ordinary Germans between 1933 and 1939. Your answer should clearly demonstrate how these three elements were interconnected and influenced each other.

Counter-Factual History

Q5. Imagine a scenario where, from 1933, the Nazi regime had genuinely prioritized improving the living standards of ordinary Germans through increased consumer goods production, higher real wages, and less emphasis on rearmament and autarky. How might this alternative economic strategy have impacted:

1. The regime's political stability and public support?
2. Germany's international position and long-term geopolitical ambitions?

Justify your reasoning with specific references to the core narrative and your understanding of Nazi ideology.

L4: Key Topic 4.4: The Persecution of Minorities, 1933–1939

LEARNING OBJECTIVES

- [ ] Demonstrate precise knowledge of Nazi racial ideology, distinguishing between 'Untermenschen' and 'Asocials'.
- [ ] Analyse the escalating stages of anti-Semitic persecution: from early boycotts (1933) to legislation (1935), bureaucratic dehumanisation (1938), and state-sponsored violence.
- [ ] Evaluate the brutal methods used against the disabled, Roma/Sinti, and homosexuals, including the Marzahn camp, sterilisation, and the T4 programme.

Recall & Retrieval

1. What was the National Labour Service (RAD)?

2. Name two ways the Nazis reduced official unemployment through 'invisible unemployment'.

3. What was 'Strength Through Joy' (Kraft durch Freude / KdF)?

4. What was the 'Beauty of Labour' (Schönheit der Arbeit / SdA)?

5. What organisation replaced all independent trade unions in May 1933?

6. What was the Volkswagen 'People's Car' scheme?

7. What were the 'Three Ks' expected of women under Nazi policy?

8. What was the Mother's Cross award?

9. What were the Edelweiss Pirates and Swing Youth?

10. What was the Gestapo?

Vocabulary Check

Spot the Deliberate Error: *Read the statement below. One historical fact or vocabulary concept has been deliberately falsified. Underline the error and explain the accurate historical reality below:*

Volksgemeinschaft | Social Darwinism | Untermenschen | Asocials | Anti-Semitism | Eugenics | Aryanisation

> *"Nazi racial policy defined the Volksgemeinschaft as an inclusive democratic community that protected Asocials and banned all Anti-Semitism and Aryanisation."*

Teacher Model / Historical Correction:



1. The Foundation: Nazi Racial Ideology Hitler's worldview, laid out in 'Mein Kampf', was built on **Social Darwinism**. He believed history was a biological struggle between the 'Master Race' (Aryans) and 'Sub-humans' ('Untermenschen'). He argued the German bloodline had to be kept pure. This ideology created two distinct targets: those who were biologically 'inferior', and those who were socially 'useless' (Asocials).

> **Lived Experience: Ruth Klüger (Jewish schoolchild in Vienna, recalling the November Pogrom (Kristallnacht) 1938)**
> "The street was littered with jagged shards of glass that crunched underfoot. The synagogue was in flames, and the fire brigade stood by, only spraying water on the neighboring German houses to protect them."

2. The Persecution of the Disabled The Nazis viewed people with physical or mental disabilities as a 'burden on the state' who cost too much money to keep alive (a concept explicitly taught in school maths lessons). * **Sterilisation:** In 1933, the 'Law for the Prevention of Hereditarily Diseased Offspring' was passed. Over 400,000 people with conditions like deafness, blindness, or epilepsy were forcibly sterilised. * **The T4 Programme (1939):** A secret state euthanasia programme. Babies and children with severe disabilities were murdered by lethal injection or starvation. Over 5,000 children were killed. This soon expanded to adults using gas chambers in psychiatric hospitals.

3. The Persecution of 'Asocials' and the Roma/Sinti * **Roma and Sinti ('Gypsies'):** Viewed as both 'Untermenschen' and 'Asocials' because they travelled and rarely held traditional jobs. Ahead of the 1936 Berlin Olympics, the Nazis wanted to 'clean up' the city. Hundreds of Roma and Sinti were arrested and forced into a miserable internment camp in **Marzahn**. In 1938, a decree ordered all Roma to be registered, preparing them for deportation to concentration camps. * **Homosexuals:** Homosexuality threatened Nazi ideals because it did not result in children for the Reich. In 1936, Himmler set up the 'Reich Office for Combating Homosexuality and Abortion'. Around 15,000 homosexual men were sent to concentration camps, forced to wear pink triangle badges, and subjected to brutal medical experiments. * **Vagrants/Beggars:** In 1933, 100,000 beggars and tramps were rounded up. Those fit enough were forced to work; others were sent to concentration camps.

4. The Escalation of Anti-Semitism (1933–1939) The persecution of Jewish people did not start with mass murder; it was a process of 'cumulative radicalisation'—slowly segregating them to normalise discrimination before ramping up the brutality. **Phase 1: Early Discrimination (1933–1934)** * **April 1933 Boycott:** The SA stood outside Jewish shops, painting Stars of David on windows and intimidating customers. * **Employment:** The Civil Service Act (1933) sacked Jewish teachers, judges, and civil servants. * **Segregation:** Local councils began banning Jewish people from public parks, swimming pools, and cinemas. **Phase 2: The Nuremberg Laws (September 1935)** These laws legally stripped Jewish people of their basic human rights: 1. **The Reich Citizenship Law:** Declared that only those of German blood could be citizens. Jewish people became 'subjects' with no right to vote or hold a German passport. 2. **The Law for the Protection of German Blood and Honour:** Forbade marriage or sexual relations between Jews and Aryans. **Phase 3: Bureaucratic Dehumanisation (1938)** Before Kristallnacht, the state systematically erased Jewish identity. * **Passports:** In October 1938, all Jewish passports had to be stamped with a large red letter **'J'**. * **Names:** A decree forced all Jewish men to add **'Israel'** to their first name, and all women to add **'Sarah'**, so they could be immediately identified on official documents.

Phase 4: State-Sponsored Violence & Forced Emigration (1938–1939) * **Kristallnacht (9/10 November 1938):** A Jewish teenager assassinated a minor German diplomat in Paris. Joseph Goebbels (trying to win Hitler's favour) used this to orchestrate a nationwide pogrom. * 'The Damage:' Over 800 shops were destroyed, 191 synagogues burned, and 91 Jewish people murdered. 30,000 Jewish men were sent to concentration camps. * Secret 'Sopade' and Gestapo reports revealed that many ordinary Germans were disgusted by Kristallnacht. This was not always out of sympathy for the Jews, but because the German public hated public disorder and the wasteful destruction of property. * **The Aftermath:** The Nazis fined the Jewish community **1 billion marks** for the damage. * **The Shift in Policy (1939):** Realising public violence was unpopular, persecution became highly bureaucratic. In January 1939, Reinhard Heydrich was put in charge of the **Reich Office for Jewish Emigration** to systematically force Jewish people out of Germany by confiscating all their wealth in exchange for exit visas.

Pair & Share Activity

Q1. Discuss with your partner: How did the Nazis justify the persecution of minorities?

True/False/Justify

Q2. Read the following statements. For each, state whether it is True or False, and then justify your answer using specific information from the lesson narrative.

1. The Nuremberg Laws primarily targeted 'asocials' and homosexuals, stripping them of their citizenship.
2. Kristallnacht was a spontaneous, unorganised outburst of public anger against Jewish businesses and synagogues.
3. The Nazi concept of 'Volksgemeinschaft' aimed to create a unified German society that embraced all citizens, regardless of their background or perceived deficiencies.

Vocabulary in Context

Q3. Using at least THREE of the keywords (Volksgemeinschaft, Social Darwinism, Untermenschen, Asocials, Anti-Semitism, Eugenics, Aryanisation), explain how the Nazi regime justified and implemented its persecution of *Jewish people* between 1933 and 1939.

Causal Linkage

Q4. Explain the causal link between core Nazi ideological concepts (such as 'Social Darwinism' and the idea of 'Untermenschen') and the specific policies of persecution enacted against *both* disabled individuals and Roma/Sinti people between 1933 and 1939.

Complex Causal Reasoning

Q5. To what extent was the persecution of *all* minority groups (Jews, Roma/Sinti, disabled, homosexuals, and 'asocials') between 1933 and 1939 driven by a single, overarching Nazi goal, or were there distinct, separate motivations for persecuting each group? Justify your answer with specific evidence from the lesson.